

Figure 1: Completes any word

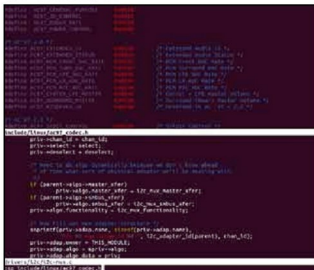


Figure 2: Horizontal split

To move the cursor from one window to another, use *TRL*+*w* *CTRL*+*w* in normal mode. This will change the active file in a round robin manner. *CTRL*+*w* <arrow key> is also used to move the cursor from one window to another.

7. Open the same file in a split window

Sometimes, there is a need to open the same file in another split window. To do this in the normal mode, use **CTRL+W v** and **CTRL+W s** to open the same file in a vertical and horizontal split of the file that is open.

8. Set abbreviations

Abbreviations are just short cuts that you type, which expand to the full, normal version of themselves. Vim provides the flexibility to define new abbreviations. In normal mode, use the command *ab* to set new abbreviations.

To define a new abbreviation, type:

```
:ab def #define
```

When you type the abbreviation in Vim, as soon as you hit the space bar, it will be expanded to the full text form. So, by typing 'def' in the file, Vim will expand this to '#define', which can make a programmer's life easier.



Figure 3: Vertical split



Figure 4: Execute shell commands without closing Vim

9. Open a file under the cursor

Often, a file contains the name of a second file, and you would like to open that second file. Here, the `'g'` command can be of great help. On using it, Vim will recognise the file name and find the same file name in the path. When the cursor is on a local variable or function, this command will jump to its declaration. To return to the previous file/cursor location, use `CTRL+o`.

10. Execute the terminal command from Vim

While using Vim, you sometimes feel like you need to close the file (Vim) and execute commands in a terminal. So let me tell you how to execute commands inside Vim without closing the file.

Let's assume you are inside the Vim editor and it has opened *somefile*.

Press *ESC* and type *:!* followed by the command. The output of the command will be listed in the terminal and after pressing *Enter*, you will be redirected to the text editor.

Figure 4 shows the syntax for executing the `ls` command on the shell through Vim.

11. View files in hex mode

Many firmware developers need to view a file in hex mode. Vim comes with a great feature to switch to hex mode when editing a file. To enter into hex mode, open a file in *vi* as usual, hit *Escape* and type `:%!xxd` to switch to hex mode.

To come out of hex mode, hit *Escape* again and type



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